

Lokesh Kistapuram

Business Analyst

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SUMMARY

Business Analyst with 3+ years of experience in delivering data-driven solutions in the Banking, Retail, and Telecom industries. Skilled in bridging the gap between business and IT through Agile, Scrum, and Waterfall methodologies. Proven ability to translate complex business requirements into actionable FRD, BRD, and SRS documentation, ensuring stakeholder alignment. Expertise in data analysis, visualization, and reporting using SQL, Power BI, Tableau, and Python, facilitating informed decision-making. Experienced in conducting cost/benefit, impact, GAP, and SWOT analyses for process optimization and operational improvements. Strong in stakeholder management, cross-functional collaboration, and business communication to achieve project success. Proficient in using Jira, MS SharePoint, MS Project, and Salesforce for effective project lifecycle management and workflow enhancement.

SKILLS

Languages: SQL, Python, SAS

Documentation: FRD, BRD, SRS, Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)

Project Management: Agile/Scrum, Waterfall, Jira, MS Project, MS SharePoint

Analysis: Cost/Benefit Analysis, Impact Analysis, GAP Analysis, Risk Analysis, SWOT Analysis

Tools: Power BI, Tableau, Excel, Figma, QlikView, Alteryx, Power Query

Data & Reporting: Data Modeling, Data Visualization, Predictive Analytics, Machine Learning

Software: Jira, MS Visio, Rational ClearQuest, Lucidchart, UAT, ERP Systems

Soft Skills: Leadership, Time Management, Stakeholder Management, Problem Solving, Communication

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant, USA | Business Analyst

Jan 2024 - Present

- Spearheaded Agile/Scrum teams as both Product Owner and Scrum Master, driving a 25% improvement in milestone delivery by optimizing backlog refinement, sprint planning, and cross-team coordination.
- Spearheaded **SharePoint** implementation for document management, resulting in a **15% reduction** in document errors and improved collaboration across project teams.
- Conducted **GAP Analysis** of As-Is vs. To-Be processes, identifying inefficiencies and leading to a **20% improvement** in operational workflows.
- Designed and maintained interactive **Tableau dashboards** to give stakeholders real-time insights into **KPIs**, driving data-driven decision-making.
- Managed and facilitated **UAT testing**, ensuring alignment with business requirements, and improving user acceptance accuracy by **10%**.
- Optimized **Salesforce Service Cloud** processes, reducing case resolution time by **20%** through automation and refined workflows.
- Facilitated **JAD sessions** and workshops, reducing project revisions by **15%** by effectively capturing and clarifying business needs.
- Developed and maintained the **RTM** using MS Excel, ensuring traceability of business requirements throughout the project lifecycle.

Key Achievement: Increased project efficiency by **15%** through optimized workflows, enhanced collaboration, and timely project deliveries.

Nevina Infotech Pvt Ltd., India | Business Analyst

April 2020 - July 2022

- Managed the full project lifecycle using **Agile** and **Waterfall methodologies**, ensuring projects met business and technical objectives.
- Authored comprehensive **BRD** and **FRD** documents, reducing development errors by **15%** and increasing clarity for development teams.
- Conducted **SWOT** and **Risk Analyses**, reducing project risks by **10%** and providing actionable recommendations to stakeholders.
- Developed **Power BI** reports, automating data extraction from SQL databases, reducing manual reporting time by **30%** and improving accuracy.
- Led process automation that improved operational efficiency by **55%**, identifying optimization opportunities through business process modelling.
- Leveraged SQL for efficient data extraction and analysis from ERP systems, reducing data analysis time by 40% and delivering actionable insights to support informed business decisions.

Key Achievement: Drove a **20% improvement** in project outcomes through process optimization and data-driven insights, contributing to better business decisions.

PROJECTS

Walmart Sales Data Analysis with MySQL

- Business Problem:** Walmart needed to analyze sales performance across regions and products to optimize strategies.
- Solution:** Used **MySQL** to extract and clean large-scale sales data, ensuring data integrity and accuracy. Designed advanced **SQL queries** to analyze **sales trends**, **product performance**, and **seasonality**, providing critical insights to stakeholders.
- Designed and deployed an interactive **Power BI** dashboard showcasing **key performance indicators** (KPIs) like total sales, profit margins, and regional performance, empowering stakeholders to implement data-driven sales optimization strategies.
- Results:** Improved sales strategy decision-making by **15%** and streamlined reporting processes, reducing manual analysis time by **25%**.

Churn Analysis Project Using SQL Server, Power BI, and Python

- Business Problem:** The company faced high customer churn rates, impacting revenue and profitability.
- Solution:** Directed an end-to-end churn analysis project utilizing **SQL Server** for **ETL** and data cleaning. Developed dynamic **Power BI** dashboards to visualize customer churn trends, risk factors, and segmentation, driving data-driven retention strategies.
- Built a **Random Forest machine learning model** in Python, improving churn prediction accuracy by **25%** and providing insights to retain high-risk customers.
- Results:** Contributed a **20% improvement** in customer retention rates by enabling proactive interventions through visualized churn predictions.

Financial Data Analysis and Dashboard Creation in Excel

- Business Problem:** Financial loan data needed in-depth analysis for loan performance tracking and decision-making.
- Solution:** Conducted comprehensive financial loan data analysis using Excel, creating dynamic dashboards with pivot tables and conditional formatting to track loan performance, default rates, and repayment trends for better financial oversight.
- Utilized **pivot tables**, **slicers**, and **conditional formatting** to automate financial reporting processes, reducing manual work by **30%**.
- Results:** Improved decision-making speed by **10%** and reduced analysis time by **30%**, contributing to more efficient loan management.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Analytics & Systems

University of Bridgeport, Bridgeport, CT

Key Achievement: "Academic Achievement Award"

Bachelor of Business Administration

Sun International Institution, Hyderabad, India

Key Achievement: "Best Student of the Year"

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst**
- SAS Certified Advanced Analytics Professional**
- Member, Delta Mu Delta - Business Honor Society**